

EAST MEETS FEED · PERFORMANCE REPORT

Account Activation Performance & Algorithm Analysis

A detailed breakdown of post-level metrics, platform growth, and algorithmic behavior across Instagram, Douyin, and Xiaohongshu during the 7-day activation period.

SUBJECT	ACTIVATION PERIOD	STRATEGIST	COURSE
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ACTIVATION SUMMARY

Total Valid KPIs: 2,191 — 4.4× the 500-person target

Likes · Comments · Shares · Saves · New Followers (video views excluded per brief)

GRAND TOTAL VALID KPIS

2,191

Target: 500 · Achieved in under 7 days · 100% organic

1,772

LIKES & SAVES

64

COMMENTS

64

SHARES

291

NEW FOLLOWERS

DOUYIN KPIS

1,888

86% of total

INSTAGRAM KPIS

201

9% of total

XIAOHONGSHU KPIS

102

5% of total

TAKEAWAY

Douyin drove **86% of all valid KPIs** despite starting with only 13 followers. One emotionally resonant post triggered the algorithmic traffic incentive system (流量激励), pushing the hero post to 24,000+ plays and converting 155 new followers in 48 hours. This confirms that on Chinese short-video platforms, **content quality and emotional resonance outweigh account authority**.

 **Douyin** @Xyjji · 抖音号: dywop2sac7pm

FOLLOWERS

13 → **258** +245

TOTAL LIKES

100 → **1,566** +1,466

VALID KPIS (EXCL. VIEWS)

1,888 86% of total

POST CAPTION	DATE	PLAYS	LIKES	COMMENTS	SHARES	SAVES	NEW FOLLOWERS
我擅长感受 却拙于表达 HERO <i>I Feel Deeply, Struggle to Express</i> 307 流量激励	May 27, 20:37	24,000	736	23	49	68	+155
我表达爱的方式很贫瘠 看着你也算其中之一 <i>My ways of expressing love are sparse — watching you is one of them</i>	May 28, 07:57	3,391	247	5	11	17	+27
幸福有时不说话 却在平淡中生根发芽 <i>Happiness sometimes doesn't speak — it quietly takes root in the ordinary</i>	May 28, 00:11	1,452	58	10	1	4	+5

DOUYIN OBSERVATION

Post 1 outperformed Posts 2 and 3 by **7-16×** on plays and engagement. The difference was not visual quality — all three used similar aesthetic footage — but **caption emotional intensity**. "我擅长感受 却拙于表达" taps directly into a universal emotion (the gap between feeling and expression), triggering Douyin's early-engagement amplification loop. Posts 2 and 3 were more situationally specific and did not achieve the same resonance threshold.



Instagram @yujiaaa_xie

PROFILE VIEWS / 30D

14.4K → **21.7K** +51%

INTERACTIONS / 30D

22 → **207** +185

FOLLOWERS

2,387 → **2,378** -9 cleaned

POST	DATE	VEWS	LIKES	COMMENTS	SHARES	SAVES	PROFILE VISITS
The Met Museum — NYC HERO <i>Cultural space · Editorial fashion · Thom Browne fit</i>	May 24	2,714	110	12	3	4	141



Xiaohongshu 谢雨佳 · 小红书号: 423553458

FANS

530 → **556** +26

LIKES & SAVES

1,892 → **1,964** +72

POST	DATE	VEWS	LIKES	COMMENTS	NEW FOLLOWERS	INTERACTION RATE	COVER CTR
纽约 🇺🇸 大都会博物馆 HERO <i>New York The Met Museum</i>	May 24	1,130	47	9	+9	6.2% ✓	23.9%
落日 朋友 酒 <i>Sunset, Friends, Drinks</i>	May 26	144	8	1	+1	—	—
幸福有时不说话 <i>Happiness Doesn't Always Speak</i>	May 28	201	8	3	—	—	—

PLATFORM MECHANICS

How Each Algorithm Works — and Why It Mattered

Understanding the distribution logic behind each platform explains why the same content produced radically different results

Instagram

SOCIAL GRAPH FIRST

CORE LOGIC

Instagram's algorithm prioritizes content from accounts users **already follow**. Discovery (Explore, Reels) is secondary and requires strong early engagement signals to break into non-followers' feeds.

KEY RANKING SIGNALS

- Saves & shares weighted higher than likes — indicate content utility
- Comments & replies signal active community engagement
- Time-spent on post (carousel swipes, video watch %) matters
- Profile visits after seeing content boost reach
- Existing follower relationship = higher distribution priority

IMPACT ON THIS CAMPAIGN

With 2,387 existing followers, Instagram had a built-in audience. The Met post generated 141 profile visits — strong conversion signal. But follower growth was minimal because Instagram's Explore reach requires either paid boost or viral-level save rate.

Douyin

INTEREST GRAPH · FORYOU

CORE LOGIC

Douyin uses a **pure interest graph** — follower count is nearly irrelevant. Every post enters a small test pool. If early engagement exceeds a threshold, it cascades to exponentially larger audiences. Any account can go viral on the first post.

KEY RANKING SIGNALS

- Completion rate (watch full video) is the #1 signal
- Early engagement velocity (first 30–60 min) determines cascade
- Shares = high-trust signal, triggers wider distribution
- Comment sentiment analyzed — emotional resonance amplified
- 流量激励 system rewards quality content with paid traffic boosts

IMPACT ON THIS CAMPAIGN

Starting from 13 followers, Post 1 triggered the cascade: 24K plays, 307 traffic incentive points, and +155 followers in 48 hours. This is only possible on Douyin — the algorithm treated a new account identically to an established one.

Xiaohongshu

SEO + COMMUNITY SIGNALS

CORE LOGIC

Xiaohongshu functions like a **search engine + social feed hybrid**. Topic tags (#tags) are the primary discovery mechanism. Without tags, content reaches only existing followers unless the cover image and title generate organic click-throughs.

KEY RANKING SIGNALS

- Tag matching — posts appear in tag search results (critical)
- Cover image click-through rate (CTR) drives initial distribution
- Saves weighted highly — signals "want to revisit" utility
- Location tags increase geo-based discovery
- Keyword density in title and caption affects search ranking

IMPACT ON THIS CAMPAIGN

Post 1 (The Met) achieved 23.9% cover CTR and a 6.2% interaction rate (rated "Good" by the platform). But without topic tags, Posts 2 and 3 had no discovery pathway — averaging only 172 views, relying entirely on the 530-person follower base.

SIDE-BY-SIDE

Algorithm Comparison: Instagram vs Douyin vs Xiaohongshu

DIMENSION	INSTAGRAM	DOUYIN	XIAOHONGSHU
Graph Type	Social graph (follows) first; interest graph secondary	Pure interest graph — follower count nearly irrelevant	Hybrid: tag/keyword search + social feed
Discovery Mechanism	Home feed (followers) · Explore tab · Reels feed	ForYou page — algorithm-curated for every user	Tag search · Keyword search · Following feed
New Account Virality	Very hard — Explore requires high engagement rate on existing followers first	Very easy — every post gets a test pool regardless of follower count	Moderate — tag strategy + strong cover image can break through
Top Engagement Signals	Saves · Shares · Comments · Time-spent	Completion rate · Shares · Early engagement velocity	Tag relevance · Cover CTR · Saves · Location tags
Content Half-Life	24–48 hrs for feed posts; Reels can resurface for weeks	First 1–2 hrs critical; viral posts resurface unpredictably	Long — tag-indexed posts discoverable for months via search
Caption Strategy	English-friendly · storytelling · calls to action	Emotional resonance · poetic/lyrical · relatable feelings	Keyword-rich · tag-heavy · descriptive + searchable
Hashtag Role	Moderate — helps Explore categorization	Low — algorithm infers topic from content + engagement	Critical — primary discovery pathway; without tags, reach collapses
Platform Incentive System	No organic boost; paid promotion only	流量激励 (traffic incentive) — free algorithmic boost for quality content	No equivalent — platform-native search ranking rewards consistency
This Campaign Result	201 KPIs · 141 profile visits · strong engagement rate on hero post	1,888 KPIs · 24K plays · +245 followers · algorithmic boost triggered	102 KPIs · 6.2% interaction rate on hero · collapsed without tags
Phase 2 Recommendation	Focus on Reels + carousel saves; target Explore through consistent posting	Maintain emotional caption brief; post at 20:00–22:00 for peak engagement window	Add 5–8 topic tags per post; use location + niche lifestyle tags; keyword-optimize titles

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

The three platforms operate on fundamentally different distribution philosophies. **Douyin rewards emotion and content quality regardless of account size** — making it the highest-leverage platform for a new creator. **Instagram rewards an existing audience** and is best suited for deepening relationships with followers already acquired. **Xiaohongshu rewards search intent and tag strategy** — it functions more like a discovery engine than a social network, and will underperform without an SEO-style tagging approach. A winning cross-platform strategy treats each platform as a distinct product, not a distribution channel.